

Strategic Audit & Governance Advisory

Board-Facing Assurance for Complex Operating Environments

Majid Mumtaz, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Dubai, UAE | Deployable Globally

majidrajpar@gmail.com | majidrajpar.github.io/portfolio_my

Traditional audit relies on 5% sampling and compliance theatre; the Board requires 100% commercial assurance

The Problem: Scaled Complexity

- ▶ **The Illusion of Coverage:** Traditional audits rely on statistical sampling, testing as little as 5% of transactions and leaving the Board blind to 95% of actual operational leakage.
- ▶ **Commercial Friction:** Legacy control frameworks are often designed by auditors who don't understand operations, creating bottlenecks that slow down the business without preventing fraud.
- ▶ **Scaling Exposures:** Fast-growing operators and pre-IPO companies rapidly outgrow their governance frameworks, exposing them to undetected supplier collusion and regulatory penalties.

The Solution: Full-Population Assurance

- ▶ **100% Algorithmic Testing:** Deploying data extraction and ML anomaly detection pipelines to test full transaction populations, bypassing legacy sampling limits.
- ▶ **Business Problem First:** Designing internal controls that reflect commercial reality, ensuring governance never slows down revenue generation.
- ▶ **Hard ROI for the Board:** Transforming the audit function from an overhead cost center into a strategic asset that recovers cash and directly reduces insurance premiums.

Try the Interactive Audit Models & Dashboards directly on my portfolio:
majidrajar.github.io/portfolio_my/tools

Standard audit sampling leaves capital exposed; targeted diagnostics and ML-driven assurance recover hard ROI

Fraud & Forensic Diagnostics

When the Board suspects leakage but standard testing returns clean.

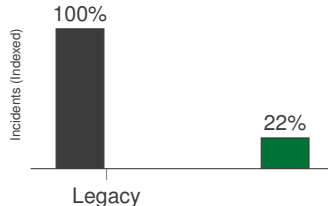
- ▶ **Methodology:** Full population data extraction coupled with ML anomaly detection.
- ▶ **Quantified ROI:** Recovered **AED 7.7M** in a single engagement from the 95% of transactions standard sampling missed.

Audit & Governance Transformation

When internal audit acts as a compliance checkbox.

- ▶ **Methodology:** Restructuring legacy methodologies to align directly with commercial realities.
- ▶ **Quantified ROI:** Reduced critical fraud incidents by **78%** during a period of 340% transaction volume surge at a GCC holding group.

Critical Fraud Incident Volume



Readiness mandates and ERM frameworks must be bulletproofed against underwriter scrutiny and cyber threats

Pre-IPO & M&A Diligence

When preparing for capital markets or acquiring targets.

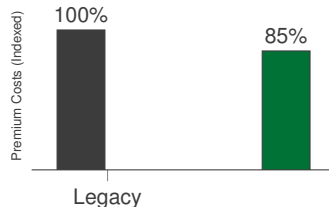
- ▶ **Methodology:** Rigorous stress-testing of ITGCs and governance frameworks against CMA standards.
- ▶ **Quantified ROI:** Uncovered **SAR 15M** in hidden exposures during buy-side due diligence, shifting negotiation leverage entirely.

Enterprise Risk & IT Governance

When boards require quantifiable assurance over systemic exposures.

- ▶ **Methodology:** Board-commissioned ERM framework design and rigorous MSSP cybersecurity oversight.
- ▶ **Quantified ROI:** Designed an ERM framework that directly informed an insurance strategy overhaul, reducing premiums by **15%**.

Group Insurance Premiums



Business Problem First, Controls Second: We design frameworks that reflect commercial reality, not just compliance

The Operating Thesis: A control that stops the business from operating is a failed control. I do not sell "best practice" compliance binders that gather dust. I build and audit controls that reflect commercial reality, utilizing automated data pipelines to monitor risk continuously without slowing down operations.

Endorsements from the Executive Suite

"Majid approaches complex matters with maturity and calm, and his recommendations are always grounded in a deep understanding of both risk and business impact. Any organisation—particularly within the F&B or consumer space—would benefit greatly from his leadership."

— Sally Swanepoel, Founder (Kitopi Colleague)

"His ability to bridge the gap between complex risk environments and practical, actionable business solutions is unmatched. Majid is a rare breed of auditor who actually understands how a business breathes."

— Steve Skoien, CEO

Flexible deployment models designed to solve immediate bottlenecks or provide sustained board-level assurance

Available for deployment via **Catalant**, **Veritux**, or **Direct Independent Contract**.

- ▶ **Targeted Diagnostics (2–4 Weeks)**

Intensive sprints to validate a specific risk or forensic suspicion using full-population data extraction and ML modeling.

- ▶ **Transformation Projects (3–6 Months)**

Extended mandates to rebuild governance frameworks, set up whistleblowing channels, or prepare an organization for an IPO.

- ▶ **Fractional CAE Advisory (Ongoing)**

Retained, board-level assurance for family offices and holding groups needing senior oversight without a full-time overhead.